

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 322

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Loretto High School boys' basketball team upon winning the 2025 TSSAA Division I, Class AA state championship.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly should salute those student athletes who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as true champions of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such exemplary group of lads is the Mustangs boys' basketball team of Loretto High School, whose members have proven themselves to be the fiercest of competitors and truly worthy of admiration by winning the 2025 TSSAA Division I, Class AA state championship; and

WHEREAS, entering regional competition as District 10 champions, Loretto quickly cleared the decks by crushing Community 65-32 in the quarterfinals, beating Grundy County 77-70 in their semifinal match-up, and defeating Cannon County 59-54 in the final to win the Region 5 championship; and

WHEREAS, the Mustangs then crushed Harpeth 71-44 in the sectional round to punch their ticket for the Big Dance; and

WHEREAS, poised for ultimate victory in the Class AA state tournament at MTSU's Murphy Center, Loretto bested Liberty Creek 49-34 in the quarterfinals and defeated Chattanooga Tyner Academy 59-47 in the semifinal round to advance to the final; and

WHEREAS, in the final game, the Mustangs prevailed over Alcoa in an overtime thriller by a score of 68-66 to claim the Gold Ball trophy that signifies a state champion and finish the 2024-2025 campaign with an outstanding 35-0 record; and

WHEREAS, with the victory, the Loretto Mustangs became the first state champion in Lawrence County history in any sport to go undefeated; they are also the second boys' basketball team in the county to win a state championship, following in the footsteps of the Loretto Mustangs team in 2018; and

WHEREAS, the members of this championship team include seniors Kasen Buie, Jaxon Roberson, and Grayson Burleson; juniors Mason Tidwell, Corben Reynolds, Jayden Aaron, Kylon Wilkerson, Casen Springer, and Dillon Thompson; sophomores Henry Serrett and Hawkins Brown; and freshmen Elijah Chapman, Paul Heineman, Landon Gable, Sam Brown, Ben Lyles, Braxton Stephenson, and Asher Sharpe; and

WHEREAS, Loretto's superb performance would not have been possible without the expert guidance of Head Coach Greg Tipps and his assistant coaches, Bryce Glass, Colin Stout, and Brendon Tipps, the commitment of managers Cooper Bromley and Drako Price, and the unfailing support of the players' families, their fans, and their community; and

WHEREAS, the members of the Loretto boys' basketball team epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved a premier level of success in competition while exhibiting the highest degree of character in all aspects of life; and

WHEREAS, the perseverance, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of young men not only made possible a championship but also surely bode well for their future success; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the Loretto Mustangs for their undefeated season on the hardwood; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the Loretto High School

boys' basketball team upon winning the 2025 TSSAA Division I, Class AA state championship, and extend to them our best wishes for every continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.